

# What Happens To Ewaste

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## What happens to e-waste after it reaches AMR Dubbo?

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Scope: TVs, computers/laptops, monitors, smartphones/tablets and printers/scanners accepted by Australian Metal Recycling (AMR), particularly the Dubbo yard at 34 Mountbatten Drive.

### Bottom line

We can now describe the front of the chain confidently, and the normal Australian back end in detail, but one crucial link is still not public:

AMR does not publicly identify the actual downstream e-waste recycler/facility that receives material from its Dubbo yard.

### 2026 forensic follow-up

A deeper search of NTCRS/co-regulator records, historical Matthews contracts, current recycler partner lists and regional Central West processing routes still did not identify a current AMR Dubbo recipient.

What it did establish:

- historical Matthews Metal Management operated some e-waste collection under the NTCRS, with a historical Matthews listing pointing to TechCollect product rules;
- historical TechCollect NSW recycler pools included Sims and TES-AMM, but no Matthews load was mapped to one of them;
- current TechCollect/ANZRP NSW recyclers are ACE Recycling Group and Sircel;
- current TechCollect public NSW collection-partner information does not identify AMR/Matthews/Dubbo;
- Sircel Parkes is the strongest regional lead because Sircel currently processes Central West e-waste and has documented Parkes/Narromine/NetWaste activity, but no AMR→Sircel evidence was found;
- ACE Recycling Group is another credible current NSW processor, but again no AMR→ACE evidence was found;
- AMR's own Rutherford yard is a documented consolidation/processing hub, but AMR does not say Dubbo e-waste is routed there.

The full candidate-by-candidate evidence test is in AMR-DUBBO-DOWNSTREAM-FORENSIC.md (AMR-DUBBO-DOWNSTREAM-FORENSIC.md).

The evidence therefore needs three labels:

- [CONFIRMED — AMR] AMR itself says it accepts the material / performs the step.
- [AUSTRALIAN BENCHMARK] this is how regulated/product-stewardship e-waste chains in Australia are documented to operate, but it is not proof that AMR uses this exact downstream chain.
- [INFERENCE] the evidence strongly points this way, but AMR has not published the missing operational detail.
- [UNKNOWN] requires AMR/downstream confirmation.

## 1. What definitely happens at the front end

### AMR takes these categories

[CONFIRMED — AMR] AMR's current material list says "Electronic waste excluding lithium ion" and explicitly lists:

- TVs
- computers / laptops
- monitors
- smart phones / tablets
- printers / scanners

AMR also says e-waste is recycled for free, while valuable scrap categories such as copper, aluminium, brass, lead, stainless steel, batteries, radiators and motors are categories it may pay for.

That means "free e-waste" should be read as no disposal charge to the customer, not "AMR pays for every e-waste item".

### Dubbo is one of AMR's regional yards

[CONFIRMED — AMR] Dubbo is at 34 Mountbatten Drive, Dubbo NSW 2830, phone (02) 6882 1033. AMR says its regional yards provide door trade, weighing and material collection.

[CONFIRMED — NSW Police] Scrap Metal Services Pty Ltd / Australian Metal Recycling is registered as scrap metal dealer SM-0759, with 34 Mountbatten Drive listed as a registered yard.

### The first physical steps

AMR does not publish a Dubbo-specific process diagram for e-waste. Based on what it does publish:

1. Material arrives by customer drop-off or collection.
2. The yard accepts/rejects material against AMR's material rules.
3. Material is weighed where relevant and can be documented with weigh tickets.
4. Different scrap/material categories are segregated and consolidated.
5. Material leaves the regional network for processing / onward sale through recycling pathways.

Steps 1-4 are consistent with AMR's described door-trade and logistics operations. Step 5 is confirmed at company-network level: AMR describes recovered material being processed and returned to supply chains, and describes its Rutherford hub receiving consolidated material for "processing and onward sale".

Important: AMR has not published evidence that the Dubbo yard itself performs specialist e-waste dismantling, shredding, battery treatment, CRT treatment, precious-metal refining or data destruction.

## 2. Is Dubbo AMR itself an e-waste processing plant?

### What AMR publicly shows

AMR's published operational equipment/capabilities include:

- excavators
- mini excavators
- semi scrap tipplers
- hook trucks
- mobile steel compactor / baler
- scrap bins
- bulk transport
- site dismantling / loading
- on-site compaction

That equipment makes sense for a scrap-metal collection, sorting, consolidation and logistics operation.

AMR's public material does not identify, at Dubbo:

- an e-waste shredder
- a manual electronics dismantling line
- optical/eddy-current/electrostatic separation equipment
- CRT processing equipment
- refrigerant recovery equipment
- lithium battery processing
- printed-circuit-board smelting/refining
- precious-metal refining
- a secure hard-drive destruction line

### **Best-supported interpretation**

[INFERENCE] The Dubbo yard is primarily a regional receiving / sorting / consolidation / transport node, not the final specialist recycler for every component inside a TV, laptop, phone or printer.

That is not a criticism. This is normal for e-waste: collection, first-stage dismantling, specialist material recovery and final refining are often done by different businesses/facilities.

[UNKNOWN] We still need the name and location of AMR Dubbo's downstream e-waste processor(s).

## **3. What a proper Australian e-waste chain looks like after collection**

This section is an Australian benchmark, not a claim that AMR uses TechCollect.

TechCollect, one of the approved National Television and Computer Recycling Scheme (NTCRS) operators, publicly documents the chain in unusually useful detail.

### **Stage 1 — dismantle, shred and sort in Australia**

[AUSTRALIAN BENCHMARK] First-stage recycling separates devices into streams such as:

- glass
- ferrous metals (steel/iron)
- non-ferrous metals (aluminium, copper etc.)
- plastics
- batteries
- printed circuit boards
- cables/wires
- ink and toner cartridges

This may involve manual dismantling, shredding and mechanical sorting.

## **Stage 2 — specialised material processing**

Separated fractions then go to specialist processors.

Some streams can be processed in Australia. TechCollect gives examples including:

- TV/monitor glass
- ink and toner
- laptop lithium-ion batteries
- selected metals and plastics

Other streams may go overseas because Australia does not have sufficient specialist downstream infrastructure for all fractions. TechCollect specifically says some plastics, metals and printed circuit boards go to approved facilities in Asia.

## **The final outputs are commodities, not "old computers"**

At the end of the chain, the original device has ceased to exist. Outputs can include:

- steel feedstock
- aluminium and copper alloys
- precious-metal-bearing refined products
- recovered lead
- glass aggregate / concrete inputs
- recycled plastics
- asphalt additives from some plastics/toner
- battery-material fractions

The useful endpoint is therefore not "the laptop is recycled into another laptop". It is the laptop is separated into commodity streams which re-enter manufacturing.

## **4. What likely happens by device type**

Again, AMR has not published its actual downstream bill of materials or processor map, so these are Australian-industry pathways rather than AMR-specific guarantees.

## **TVs**

### **Modern LCD/LED televisions**

Typical recoverable streams include:

- steel/aluminium chassis and frames
- copper wire/cabling
- printed circuit boards
- plastics
- screen/glass fractions

Older LCD equipment can contain mercury-bearing lamps and therefore needs controlled handling.

Australian benchmark: TechCollect says TV and monitor glass can be recycled in Australia into concrete/building products, while selected metals/plastics are recovered and some fractions go to specialist overseas facilities.

### **CRT televisions**

CRT glass can contain substantial lead and requires specialist treatment.

Australian benchmark: TechCollect says leaded CRT glass can be processed so lead is recovered for batteries/building-material applications.

AMR uncertainty: AMR's website says "TVs" and "monitors", but does not separately state whether it accepts CRT units. Confirm before taking CRTs.

## **Desktop computers**

Typical streams:

- steel case -> ferrous metal recycling
- aluminium heat sinks/cases -> aluminium stream
- copper wiring/coils -> copper stream
- motherboard/cards -> PCB stream for precious/base-metal recovery
- power supply -> steel/copper/electronics fractions
- plastics -> sorted plastic stream where viable
- HDD/SSD -> data-bearing device requiring deliberate sanitisation/destruction before material recovery

For Dubbo eWaste, do not treat ordinary AMR recycling as a data-destruction service unless AMR gives you a specific written process/certificate.

## **Laptops**

Laptops contain:

- aluminium/magnesium/steel structures depending on model

- copper
- PCBs
- display glass/electronics
- SSD/HDD storage
- plastics
- lithium-ion battery

This exposes the biggest contradiction in AMR's published policy:

AMR explicitly lists computers/laptops as accepted e-waste, but also says electronic waste excluding lithium ion and separately says lithium batteries are not accepted.

[UNKNOWN] Does AMR require a removable laptop battery to be taken out? Does it accept a modern laptop with an internally glued/screwed lithium battery? The website does not say.

Until this is answered, Dubbo eWaste should not assume intact battery-equipped laptops can go to AMR.

## Smartphones

A phone contains small quantities of high-value materials:

- copper
- aluminium/steel
- gold, silver, palladium and other metals in circuit boards
- glass
- plastics
- lithium-ion battery

AMR explicitly lists smartphones/tablets but also excludes lithium ion, so the same policy conflict exists.

For comparison, MobileMuster publishes a very clear specialist pathway:

1. phones are transported to recycling facilities in Sydney or Melbourne;
2. devices are manually dismantled;
3. circuit boards, metals, glass, plastics and batteries are separated;
4. some metals/plastics are processed in Australia;
5. circuit boards, batteries and some plastics go to its recycling partner in Singapore;
6. more than 95% of phone material can be recovered;
7. devices are not resold through the recycling stream and residual data is physically destroyed in the process.

This is MobileMuster's process, not evidence of AMR's process.

## Practical choice for Dubbo eWaste

Until AMR explains its battery rule, MobileMuster is the clearer end-of-life route for zero-value phones because its system is explicitly designed around phones with lithium batteries and documents both battery and data handling.

## **Tablets**

Tablets are materially similar to phones/laptops:

- display/glass
- aluminium/plastic enclosure
- PCB
- small speakers/cables
- lithium battery

AMR lists them, but its lithium exclusion is unresolved.

Note that MobileMuster does not accept tablets/iPads; TV/computer product-stewardship routes such as NTCRS can cover tablets as computer products.

## **Monitors**

Typical streams:

- steel/plastic casing
- circuit boards
- copper wire
- LCD/glass or CRT glass depending on type

Flat-screen and CRT monitors are explicitly covered under the NTCRS product categories.

Again, AMR lists "monitors" generally but does not say whether CRT monitors are acceptable at Dubbo.

## **Printers and scanners**

Typical streams:

- large plastic housings
- steel frames
- motors
- wiring/copper
- PCBs
- scanner glass
- ink/toner consumables

Australian benchmark: TechCollect says ink/toner can be processed into products such as asphalt.

AMR accepts printers/scanners but also says it does not accept plastic or items without metal. A printer contains plenty of metal, but is often plastic-heavy.

[UNKNOWN] whether AMR expects ink/toner cartridges to be removed first, and how the Dubbo downstream chain handles them.

## **5. Why can AMR take e-waste "for free"?**

There are three different economic mechanisms that can make free collection possible. Only one is directly confirmed for AMR.

### **1. Recoverable material value — confirmed principle**

[CONFIRMED — AMR] AMR is a metal recycler. It says value varies with material type, grade, quantity, cost to collect/handle/process and commodity market conditions.

E-waste contains steel, aluminium, copper, circuit boards and other valuable fractions. Their recovered value can offset collection/processing costs.

But the amount of metal value does not mean every e-waste load is profitable by itself.

### **2. Product stewardship funding — how NTCRS works, but NOT confirmed for AMR**

The Australian Government's NTCRS provides households and small businesses free recycling of TVs and computer products. It is industry funded: liable importers/manufacturers pay through approved co-regulatory arrangements for collection and recycling.

Under the scheme:

- approved co-regulatory arrangements must use recyclers certified to AS 5377;
- the material-recovery target is 90% by weight;
- annual reporting includes collection, storage, recycling, exports and contracted service providers.

Critical gap: no current public source found in this research establishes that AMR Dubbo is an NTCRS collection site or contracted AS 5377 recycler.

So we should not claim AMR's current free service is NTCRS-funded unless AMR identifies the co-regulatory arrangement it works under.

### **3. Commercial/council contracts — plausible, not confirmed for current Dubbo e-waste**

AMR works with businesses, councils and government clients and advertises compliant recycling pathways, weigh tickets and certificates of recycling for project work.

The old Matthews operation historically handled council e-waste in the region.

But Dubbo Regional Council's documented Matthews e-waste contract ended 30 June 2025, and a replacement/current contract has not been found publicly.

[UNKNOWN] whether current Dubbo e-waste is subsidised by a council contract, NTCRS contract, commodity value, AMR absorbing the cost as part of its wider metal business, or a combination.

## 6. Certification and traceability: what AMR says versus what is proven

### What AMR says

On its Tamworth service page AMR advertises:

- EPA-compliant transport and processing
- processing through licensed facilities
- independent weigh tickets
- full traceability/documentation
- certificates of recycling
- photographic evidence
- project summary reports

This is useful company-level evidence that AMR can support documented commercial recycling pathways.

### What has NOT been established

This research did not find public proof that:

- the Dubbo yard is AS 5377 certified;
- AMR is currently contracted to an NTCRS co-regulatory arrangement;
- AMR's downstream e-waste processor is AS 5377 certified;
- a certificate of recycling is automatically supplied for small free drop-offs;
- AMR supplies serial-number-level data-destruction certificates;
- AMR itself destroys storage media;
- all material remains in Australia.

Those are questions to get in writing before using AMR as the documented downstream processor for school/business equipment.

## 7. Data-bearing equipment: the important risk for Dubbo eWaste

AMR is advertising material recycling, not a secure IT asset disposition/data destruction service.

There is no current AMR page found that promises:

- NIST 800-88 sanitisation
- hard-drive shredding
- serialised destruction certificates
- chain of custody for drives
- destruction of residual customer data

Therefore Dubbo eWaste should:

1. sanitise HDD/SSD/NVMe itself using the agreed standard; or

2. physically remove data-bearing media and send it to a verified secure-destruction provider;
3. never rely on "it is going to recycling" as proof that data has been destroyed.

MobileMuster is different: its published phone recycling process explicitly says devices are physically destroyed and residual data is destroyed. That guarantee applies to MobileMuster, not AMR.

## **8. Overseas processing does not automatically mean dumping**

A legitimate Australian recycling chain may export separated fractions for specialist recovery.

The Commonwealth says e-waste can be whole products, components or shredded material, and e-waste should be presumed hazardous unless shown otherwise. Hazardous e-waste exports are controlled under the Hazardous Waste (Regulation of Exports and Imports) Act 1989 and Basel Convention arrangements.

Potential hazardous parts include:

- lead in CRT glass and solder
- cadmium
- mercury
- brominated flame-retardant plastics
- some batteries
- some photocopier/printer components

So a lawful downstream chain can include overseas processing, but it needs to comply with the relevant hazardous-waste/export controls.

TechCollect provides a useful example: it says first-stage recycling occurs in Australia, then some sorted fractions such as circuit boards and some plastics/metals go to approved Asian facilities because suitable Australian end-markets do not exist for everything.

Again, AMR has not publicly disclosed its own export/downstream map.

## **9. The chain we can safely put on a Dubbo eWaste process map today**

### **Confirmed / defensible**

Dubbo eWaste

- triage for reuse/refurbishment
- remove/sanitise data-bearing storage
- separate problematic lithium batteries
- Australian Metal Recycling, 34 Mountbatten Drive for material it confirms it accepts
- AMR weighs/sorts/consolidates material within its recycling network
- [UNKNOWN NAMED DOWNSTREAM E-WASTE PROCESSOR]
- dismantling/shredding/material separation
- specialist processors/refiners in Australia and potentially overseas
- recovered steel, aluminium, copper, glass, plastics, precious-metal fractions etc. re-enter manufacturing.

## **What we must NOT claim yet**

Do not publish statements such as:

- "AMR shreds our laptops in Dubbo."
- "AMR destroys all customer data."
- "AMR is an NTCRS recycler."
- "AMR is AS 5377 certified."
- "AMR sends e-waste to [company/facility]."
- "everything stays in Australia."
- "AMR recovers 90%."

None of those have been established for AMR Dubbo.

The 90% recovery target belongs to approved NTCRS co-regulatory arrangements, not automatically to every business that advertises free e-waste recycling.

## **10. Questions that will close almost every remaining gap**

Ask AMR Dubbo / AMR management these exact questions:

1. Where does it go?

"After I drop computers/TVs/printers at Dubbo, what is the next physical facility they go to? Can you give me the recycler's company name and suburb?"

2. What happens at Dubbo?

"Do you dismantle or shred any e-waste at 34 Mountbatten Drive, or is Dubbo collection/sorting/consolidation only?"

3. NTCRS?

"Is this free e-waste service part of the National Television and Computer Recycling Scheme? If yes, which approved co-regulatory arrangement do you work for?"

4. AS 5377?

"Which facility in the chain holds AS 5377 certification? Can I have the certificate number/scope?"

5. Lithium contradiction?

"Your website lists laptops, smartphones and tablets but says e-waste excludes lithium ion. Do I remove batteries first? What do you do with devices where the battery isn't reasonably removable?"

6. CRT?

"Do you accept CRT TVs and CRT monitors at Dubbo?"

7. Printers?

"Do ink/toner cartridges need to be removed from printers first?"

8. Data?

"Do you offer secure destruction of hard drives/SSDs, and can you issue a serial-numbered destruction certificate? If not, should I remove all storage first?"

#### 9. Documentation?

"For a small commercial drop-off, can you give me a weight ticket and certificate of recycling that identifies the load/date?"

#### 10. Overseas fractions?

"Are any e-waste fractions exported for downstream processing? If so, what types and which countries/processors?"

#### 11. Free service economics?

"Is the free e-waste drop-off funded under NTCRS/a council contract, or is it simply AMR's own commercial service?"

#### 12. Commercial limits?

"Is there a limit or minimum for a small business, and at what volume would you collect from us?"

If AMR answers those in writing, the downstream section of this repo can move from an evidence-based model to an actual chain-of-custody map.

## 11. Recommended downstream split for the pilot

Until those answers arrive:

Material | Pilot downstream route  
Reusable PCs/laptops/monitors | Refurbish/resell first  
Dead desktops/PC parts with no batteries | AMR candidate; confirm acceptance  
HDD/SSD/NVMe | Sanitise/remove before AMR; keep wipe/destruction evidence  
Laptops with lithium battery | Do not assume AMR accepts intact; confirm battery rule  
Dead mobile phones | Prefer MobileMuster until AMR's lithium rule is clarified  
Tablets | Use an NTCRS-compatible route unless AMR confirms battery handling  
Flat-screen TVs/monitors | AMR lists them; confirm Dubbo commercial terms  
CRT TVs/monitors | Hold/refuse until AMR confirms CRT acceptance  
Printers/scanners | AMR lists them; ask whether cartridges must be removed  
Loose lithium batteries | Not AMR; use approved battery pathway  
Lead-acid batteries | AMR accepts non-lithium batteries

This keeps the pilot defensible while the exact downstream chain is still being verified.

## 12. Sources

### Australian Metal Recycling

- AMR main site / current material list: <https://australianmetalrecycling.com.au/>
- AMR services / free e-waste: <https://australianmetalrecycling.com.au/services/>
- AMR drop-off / all-yard door trade: <https://australianmetalrecycling.com.au/drop-off/>
- AMR contact / Dubbo: <https://australianmetalrecycling.com.au/contact/>
- AMR National Recycling Week 2025 article / regional network and consolidation: <https://australianmetalrecycling.com.au/rescuing-scrap-metal-across-nsw/>

- AMR Tamworth / equipment, traceability, licensed facilities, certificates:  
<https://australianmetalrecycling.com.au/scrap-metal-recycling-tamworth/>

## Australian Government / NTCRS

- DCCEEW — National Television and Computer Recycling Scheme:  
<https://www.dcceew.gov.au/environment/protection/waste/product-stewardship/television-computer-recycling-scheme>
- DCCEEW — Roles and responsibilities: <https://www.dcceew.gov.au/environment/protection/waste/product-stewardship/products-schemes/television-computer-recycling-scheme>
- DCCEEW — Co-regulatory arrangements / AS 5377 / 90% material-recovery target:  
<https://www.dcceew.gov.au/environment/protection/waste/product-stewardship/products-schemes/television-computer-recycling-scheme/coreg-arrangements>
- DCCEEW — Information for recyclers: <https://www.dcceew.gov.au/environment/protection/waste/product-stewardship/products-schemes/television-computer-recycling-scheme/recyclers>
- DCCEEW — How to recycle e-waste / covered NTCRS products:  
<https://www.dcceew.gov.au/environment/protection/waste/consumers/recycling-drop-off>
- Federal Register — Recycling and Waste Reduction (Product Stewardship—Televisions and Computers) Rules 2021, current compilation: <https://www.legislation.gov.au/F2021L00624/latest>

## Detailed example of an Australian TV/computer recycling chain

- TechCollect — Where does our e-waste go?: <https://techcollect.com.au/about-us/where-does-our-e-waste-go/>

## Phones

- MobileMuster — FAQs / detailed recycling pathway: <https://www.mobilemuster.com.au/frequently-asked-questions/>
- MobileMuster — recycling process: <https://www.mobilemuster.com.au/recycling/>

## Export controls

- DCCEEW — Control of e-waste for export, import and transit:  
<https://www.dcceew.gov.au/environment/protection/hazardous-waste/control-e-waste>

## Current operator evidence

- NSW Police Scrap Metal Industry Register, 19 February 2026:  
[https://www.police.nsw.gov.au/data/assets/pdf\\_file/0019/743500/Public\\_Register\\_19\\_Feb\\_2026.pdf](https://www.police.nsw.gov.au/data/assets/pdf_file/0019/743500/Public_Register_19_Feb_2026.pdf)
- ABR — Scrap Metal Services Pty Ltd / Australian Metal Recycling, ABN 51 640 765 091:  
<https://abr.business.gov.au/ABN/View?abn=51640765091>

# 13. Regional council chain-of-custody evidence

This section goes beyond AMR and records the strongest evidence found for what actually happens after e-waste is dropped at surrounding council sites.

## What is proven, council by council

Council / area | Proven collection point | Named downstream evidence | What we can actually say happens

Dubbo / Wellington | Whylandra and Wellington accept household e-waste | Historical Council documents named Matthews Metal Management; that listed contract ended 30 June 2025. NetWaste currently says Sims collects e-waste from the majority of member councils, but does not identify Dubbo specifically. | 2026 processor still unknown. E-waste is separated from general waste and sent for recycling, but the present processor/final destination is not publicly named.

Parkes | Parkes Waste Facility | Parkes Shire's 2024-25 report says e-waste from Parkes Landfill was collected by Sircel. Its 2025-26 report records continued work on an e-waste/shared agreement with Sircel. | This is the strongest current nearby chain: Parkes collection -> Sircel. Sircel has a processing site at 55 Brolgan Road, Parkes.

Coonamble | Coonamble Waste Management Facility; e-waste is a free separated stream | February 2025 Council papers say Matthews Metals Dubbo agreed to work with Coonamble Waste for collection and disposal of e-waste and batteries. | Proven 2025 route: Coonamble -> Matthews Metals Dubbo. Whether that arrangement continues in 2026 under AMR is not publicly proven.

Narromine | Narromine Waste Management Facility; domestic e-waste no charge | Council says e-waste collections are organised through NetWaste. Sircel has publicly reported receiving regional e-waste from Narromine at Parkes, but current council contract routing is not published. | Sircel/Parkes has been used in practice; current exclusive route not proven.

Warren / Forbes / Mid-Western and most NetWaste councils | Current NetWaste map lists Ewenmar/Warren, Daroobalgie/Forbes, Mudgee, Gulgong, Kandos etc. | NetWaste currently says Sims Metal Management collects e-waste from the majority of NetWaste councils. | Exact council-by-council route is not disclosed. A historical NetWaste contract explicitly sent e-waste to Sims St Marys for shredding.

Mudgee | Mudgee Waste Facility | Council has a Revolve/Tip Shop reuse stream as well as e-waste collection | Clear evidence of a reuse opportunity before material recycling, but the downstream processor for rejected/unsold e-waste is not publicly named.

Gilgandra / Nyngan | Public information is incomplete/inconsistent | No current named processor found | These remain genuine information gaps requiring direct Council confirmation.

## **The historical Sims/St Marys process is unusually explicit**

NetWaste's 2023-2027 regional strategy records the then regional scrap-metal contractor as Sims Metal Management, with McCabe Transport as collection subcontractor. It says the e-waste option was shredded at the St Marys depot, with a trial involving E-cycle Solutions for further recovery/co-regulatory participation.

That gives a concrete historical chain:

Council e-waste cage -> regional collection -> Sims St Marys -> shredding -> further material recovery.

Do not label this the confirmed 2026 Dubbo route. The named contract dates have passed. NetWaste's current e-waste page still names Sims as the majority collector, but does not say that every current load still goes to St Marys.

## **Parkes/Sircel: what specifically happens to the devices**

Sircel's current published process is much more detailed:

1. Collection and secure transport to a Sircel facility.
2. Receival and weighing; each lot gets a tracking number.
3. Triage:
  - batteries, large plastics, steel and wood are removed/separated;
  - equipment suitable for reuse/repurposing is diverted to ITAD rather than destroyed.
4. Data-bearing reusable devices can be sanitised with Blancco and supplied with digitally signed erasure certificates.
5. End-of-life whole devices (without batteries) enter a multi-stage mechanical size-reduction and separation process.
6. Material is reduced as far as <1 mm fractions.
7. Separated commodities include steel, aluminium, copper and other recoverable fractions.
8. Sircel says it performs additional in-house metallurgical recovery of base, precious and platinum-group metals.
9. Recovered steel/copper and other commodities are sent back into manufacturing; plastics go to certified downstream manufacturing partners.

10. Batteries are handled separately through accredited downstream partners rather than through Sircel's standard mechanical line.

For a good laptop, the most important step is step 3. If it can be reused, the whole device can retain far more value than if it is mechanically reduced to metal/plastic/PCB fractions.

## **What "recycled" looks like in real Australian NTCRS numbers**

A useful audited-scale benchmark is Ecycle Solutions' 2023-24 NTCRS annual report. This is national Ecycle data, not Dubbo-specific.

- 45,617,361 kg was recorded as recycled.
- 41,692,686 kg became usable materials.
- 3,587,297 kg went to landfill including downstream losses.
- 337,378 kg remained as recycled material stored at recyclers at year end.
- The report states a 92.14% recovery/conversion rate.
- It also reports 15,628,808 kg of reusable material exported for use in new goods, including metals, circuit boards, plastics and hard drives.

So in a real large NTCRS chain, "recycled" does not mean every kilogram becomes a new product. Most becomes usable commodity feedstock, while a measurable residual still ends up in landfill.

## **NTCRS sets the standard for TVs/computers**

Under the National Television and Computer Recycling Scheme:

- approved co-regulatory arrangements must meet a 90% material recovery target by weight;
- they must report collection, storage, recycling, exports and contracted service providers;
- scheme recyclers must meet the applicable AS 5377 requirements.

That is the standard Dubbo E-Waste should seek from any downstream partner handling TVs/computers for business or school clients.

## **Scrap metal and e-waste are now clearly separate contract questions**

A late-2025 NetWaste tender for Collection and Recycling of Scrap Metal (F4459) was awarded by participating councils to Access Recycling. This is useful because it shows the regional metal contract changed.

However, this does not establish that Access Recycling replaced Sims for e-waste. NetWaste's current e-waste page still says Sims handles the majority of council e-waste. Treat scrap metal and e-waste as separate streams until a council confirms otherwise.

## **The exact opportunity for Dubbo E-Waste**

Council/recycler systems are very good at:

collect -> consolidate -> shred/process -> recover commodities

The missing layer is often:

inspect -> test -> data-wipe -> repair -> redeploy/resell -> only recycle when genuinely end-of-life

That is the strongest regional role for Dubbo E-Waste. A functioning 8 GB laptop with an SSD should ideally be captured before it becomes anonymous bulk e-waste.

## Questions now worth getting answered in writing

For each surrounding council:

1. Who is your current e-waste contractor in 2026?
2. What physical facility does the truck take the material to next?
3. Does the contract permit reuse/repair diversion before recycler pickup?
4. Who owns an item after a resident deposits it?
5. Does the contractor get exclusive rights to the e-waste stream?
6. Is any device triaged for reuse before shredding?
7. What data-destruction standard is used?
8. Is the recycler AS 5377 certified / operating under NTCRS?
9. What percentage is reused, materially recovered and landfilled?
10. Can Council provide the last 12 months of e-waste tonnage?
11. Would Council trial a separate reuse-first electronics cage/referral pathway?

## Additional sources for this regional deep dive

- NetWaste current e-waste page: <https://www.netwaste.com.au/ewaste/>
- NetWaste Regional Waste and Sustainable Materials Strategy 2023-2027 (historical St Marys shredding route): [https://netwaste.com.au/wp-content/uploads/2023/03/TW22135\\_NetWaste\\_Regional-Waste-and-Sustainable-Materials-Strategy-2023-2027\\_5.0.pdf](https://netwaste.com.au/wp-content/uploads/2023/03/TW22135_NetWaste_Regional-Waste-and-Sustainable-Materials-Strategy-2023-2027_5.0.pdf)
- Parkes Shire 2024-25 progress report (Sircel collection): [https://www.parkes.nsw.gov.au/files/assets/public/v/1/council/strategies-and-plans/operational-plan-amp-budget/2024-25\\_op-plan\\_progress\\_report\\_jan-to-june-2025-infocouncil-final.pdf](https://www.parkes.nsw.gov.au/files/assets/public/v/1/council/strategies-and-plans/operational-plan-amp-budget/2024-25_op-plan_progress_report_jan-to-june-2025-infocouncil-final.pdf)
- Parkes Shire 2025-26 progress report: [https://www.parkes.nsw.gov.au/files/assets/public/v/2/council/strategies-and-plans/operational-plan-amp-budget/ecm\\_2191606\\_v2\\_ipr-operational-plan-2025-2026-progress-report-july-to-december-2025.pdf](https://www.parkes.nsw.gov.au/files/assets/public/v/2/council/strategies-and-plans/operational-plan-amp-budget/ecm_2191606_v2_ipr-operational-plan-2025-2026-progress-report-july-to-december-2025.pdf)
- Coonamble Shire February 2025 business paper (Matthews Dubbo arrangement): [https://www.coonambleshire.nsw.gov.au/media\\_downloads/business-papers-minutes/2025/250212\\_1.Business\\_Paper-\\_Ordinary\\_Meeting\\_February\\_2025.pdf](https://www.coonambleshire.nsw.gov.au/media_downloads/business-papers-minutes/2025/250212_1.Business_Paper-_Ordinary_Meeting_February_2025.pdf)
- Sircel current process: <https://sircel.com/how-we-work/our-process/>
- Sircel ITAD/reuse/data sanitisation: <https://sircel.com/services/itad-asset-recovery-repurposing/>
- Sircel Parkes location: <https://sircel.com/contact-us/>
- DCCEEW Ecycle Solutions 2023-24 annual report: <https://www.dcceew.gov.au/environment/protection/waste/publications/ecycle-solutions-annual-report-2023-24>
- DCCEEW NTCRS co-regulatory requirements / 90% recovery target: <https://www.dcceew.gov.au/environment/protection/waste/product-stewardship/products-schemes/television-computer-recycling-scheme/coreg-arrangements>

## 14. Research status

High confidence

- AMR Dubbo location/operator.

- categories AMR publicly lists.
- e-waste is offered as free recycling.
- lithium batteries are excluded.
- Australian NTCRS and MobileMuster downstream processes described above.

#### Medium confidence / inference

- Dubbo functions mainly as a receiving/sorting/consolidation/logistics yard for e-waste rather than the final specialist processor.

#### Still unknown

- exact AMR Dubbo downstream recycler(s)
- exact facility where each e-waste type is dismantled/shredded
- whether AMR's free e-waste offer is funded through NTCRS
- current AS 5377 certification in AMR's chain
- exact material recovery rate for AMR e-waste
- whether any AMR e-waste fractions are exported, and where
- secure-data-destruction process
- battery-removal rules for laptops/phones/tablets
- CRT acceptance
- cartridge/toner rules

## Reuse-first model deep dive

The most strategically relevant part of Sircel is not the industrial shredding line; it is the decision system before destruction. Sircel tracks incoming lots, triages devices for reuse, sanitises data with Blancco, hardware-tests reuse candidates, then routes passing devices to reuse/redeployment/charity/approved brokers. Its FY2023-24 ESG report records 2,350 items reused and explicitly says significant numbers of incoming laptops and desktops were still working.

That workflow has now been researched separately as a potential core operating model for Dubbo E-Waste: SIRCEL-ITAD-REUSE-MODEL.md (SIRCEL-ITAD-REUSE-MODEL.md).

## TechCollect and whole-device reuse

A dedicated review of TechCollect's current policy found an important boundary:

- TechCollect says products collected through its normal recycling stream are not sold second-hand for reuse.
- It recommends that equipment still working and current enough to be useful in Australia be given to family, friends or charity before it enters TechCollect.
- Once surrendered, TechCollect's published path is first-stage recycling in Australia: dismantling, shredding and sorting.
- ANZRP's reuse activity happens through separate upstream initiatives, especially PonyUp for Good, The Reconnect Project and The Laptop Initiative.
- PonyUp explicitly performs reuse triage, data erasure, refurbishment and remarketing before ANZRP takes the non-reusable remainder for recycling.

See TECHCOLLECT-REUSE-DEEP-DIVE.md (TECHCOLLECT-REUSE-DEEP-DIVE.md) for the full evidence and implications.

